

Delaware County Council Meeting - September 22nd, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CIKqfk4YjoQ
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Target Category	delaware_county

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2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The County Council regular meeting was called to order on September 22nd by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Langan (Flanigan), Mr. Whead (Whitehead), Mr. Mole (Mogul), Mr. Bookout, Miss Piper, Mr. Can (Chance), Mr. Hughes, and Mr. Freeman.
 - **Members Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named in opening roll call, but leading the agenda.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** The August 25th council meeting minutes were approved as amended by voice/roll call vote following noted corrections.
- **Agenda Adjustment:** The agenda was amended at the start to move Miss Dy's presentation first due to a prior engagement.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:04:10 Fair and Expo Appropriation

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carrie (representing the Fair Board).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Carrie presented a request for an appropriation under County General (Fair and Expo) totaling \$55,000 to cover operating supplies (\$5,000), contractual services (\$40,000 to reimburse an accounting company for payroll expenses), utility services gas (\$5,000), and building/highway repairs and maintenance (\$5,000). The council discussed billing delays from the accounting company and target cash balances (roughly \$300,000).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.

00:08:37 Commissioners Transfer (Electric Utilities & Position)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners' Office.
- **Deliberation Summary:** A transfer within County General commissioners' budget moving funds from an unfunded maintenance technician position (-\$30,490) and pre-employment costs (-\$1,500) to utility electric services (\$31,990), resulting in a net-zero transfer. Council members noted a review of astronomical electric bills is underway with the auditor's office.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.

00:11:30 Treasurer's Office Transfer

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented in the absence of Treasurer staff due to the AIC (Association of Indiana Counties) meeting conflict.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer within the Treasurer's budget moving \$370 from health insurance to educational pay (net-zero transfer).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.

00:13:07 Board of Health Transfer

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jamie Bane, Health Department Administrator.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$500 from health insurance to educational pay to cover an educational incentive approved in the employee handbook. Discussion ensued regarding the start date and proration of educational incentives (tied to September 8th commissioner approval or credential submission dates).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.

00:16:35 Sheriff's Office Appropriation (Fair Overtime)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tony Skinner, Delaware County Sheriff.
- **Deliberation Summary:** An appropriation request of \$14,910 under County General (Sheriff) for overtime pay, representing a reimbursement from funds paid by the fair board to the county general fund.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.

00:18:32 Commissioners Appropriation (Utilities: Electric & Sewage)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners' Office.
- **Deliberation Summary:** An additional appropriation request totaling \$236,510 (\$156,510 for electric and \$80,000 for sewage) to cover utility expenses through the remainder of the year.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.

00:21:03 Auditor's Office Appropriation & Open Gov Project

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ed / Auditor's Office staff.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Request for additional appropriations totaling \$65,393 covering accounting administrator salary adjustments, project/compliance leader adjustments, educational pay, FICA, PERF, workers' comp, and \$52,385 for contractual services (Open Gov software project). Extensive debate occurred regarding department buy-in, scope of Open Gov modules (performance management, asset management, permitting/licensing), and existing software contracts (such as Biolytics in the highway department).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** **Approved as Amended** (Line item 311 for contractual services / Open Gov was removed via motion by Jim, bringing the approved additional appropriation total down to \$13,085). Approved by Roll Call Vote (Mr. Whitehead voted no).

00:47:07 Major Transfer: Data IT to Auditor

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tanya Dunborn, Chief Deputy Auditor / Ryan (IT).
- **Deliberation Summary:** A major transfer of \$93,584.90 moving software maintenance funds from Data IT (repair & maintenance software) to the Auditor's contractual services line to correct a mispayment error regarding annual software maintenance (GUTS/PBD property tax system and VIP software) paid out of the wrong budget. Discussion focused on the lack of formal written documentation assigning software financial responsibilities across departments.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.

00:35:35 (Note: Item out of sequence in transcript) / 00:55:35 Sheriff's Office Inmate Medical Care Major Transfer & Appropriation

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tony Skinner, Delaware County Sheriff.
- **Deliberation Summary:** A major transfer of \$57,000 from the Inmate Medical Care Fund (4914) to Jail contractual services (311), paired with a companion additional appropriation request of \$57,000. The Sheriff explained that jail medical costs<U+2014>including off-site treatments like dialysis, wound care, prescriptions, and dental bills<U+2014>have surged significantly, driven by a current jail population of roughly 420 inmates.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Major Transfer: Approved by Roll Call Vote.
 - Additional Appropriation (\$57,000): Approved by Roll Call Vote.

01:03:27 Misdemeanor Fund Appropriation

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tony Skinner, Delaware County Sheriff.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Additional appropriation request of \$100,000 from the Misdemeanor Fund (1175) for contractual services to further support inmate medical bills. Council discussed the resulting cash balance of the fund (projected around \$106,000).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.

01:05:02 Assessor's Office Appropriation

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Candy Abbott (representing the Assessor's Office).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Request for educational pay under Reassessment (1224). Following discussion on proration tied to the September 8th commissioner policy, the request was amended down from \$1,200 to \$370 to cover remaining pay periods.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** **Approved as Amended** for \$370 by Roll Call Vote.

01:30:27 Drug-Free Community Fund Appropriation

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jennifer Lavel Moore, Executive Director, Delaware County Prevention Council.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Annual request for funds from the Drug-Free Community Fund (Fund 1148, misspoken in transcript as 1145) totaling \$23,611 to support substance misuse programming by DCPC and community organizations.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.

01:09:03 High-Tech Crime Unit Appropriation

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chuck Zimmers, High-Tech Crime Unit Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Additional appropriation of \$1,300 for software repairs and maintenance, representing unspent state administrative allotment funds returned to the unit by the state of Indiana.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:22:37 Rick Yenser** (Newsman, Author): Addressed the council regarding rising government operating costs at the jail and highways, expressed concern that live streaming and pandemic shifts have reduced physical public attendance at meetings, cautioned against depleting cash balances, and noted ongoing debt obligations for past county projects.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Civic Center Authority Appointment:** J. Patrick Wright (attorney with Cannon Bruns and Murphy) was unanimously appointed as the Democratic representative on the Civic Center Authority board for a two-year term, following partisan vetting.
 - **County Facility Hours Discussion:** Council members held a discussion recommending that the commissioners work toward ensuring all county facilities maintain at least 40 operational hours per week to better serve working citizens.
 - **Upcoming Meetings:** The LIT (Local Income Tax) study committee meets next Tuesday at 4:00 PM. The council will take a 10-minute recess before convening budget hearings, with a goal to adopt the budget on Wednesday, October 7th at 9:00 AM. The next regular council meeting is scheduled for Tuesday, October 27th at 9:00 AM.
 - **Adjournment:** The regular meeting was officially adjourned following a motion by Jessica and a second by Dan, approved by roll call vote.
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